

Shalini Rao

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Product designer with 5 years of experience, including 3.5 in B2B SaaS, owning end-to-end workflow design and AI-powered features across a broad product surface. Comfortable in codebases, fast with AI tools, and most useful when the team is small.

EXPERIENCE

Arc XP (*The Washington Post*) — Product Designer 2

September 2022 - May 2026

Arc XP is a B2B SaaS content management system owned and distributed by *The Washington Post*, empowering publishers and broadcasters to deliver high-quality content worldwide.

- Redesigned the primary video editing workflow from the ground up, modernizing a decade-old interface into a React experience consistent with the broader product suite. Led design from initial research through engineering handoff and QA in close partnership with a PM; reduced video publish turnaround time by over 50%.
- Identified audio as a gap in the asset management suite and drove it from zero to a shipped multi-phase product. Conducted competitive analysis to define scope and owned UX across three release phases, including generative AI text-to-speech integration. Prototyped V1 in Figma Make; shipped product reflects original prototype with minimal deviation.
- Designed field-level suggestion treatment for a generative AI editorial assistant, including inline diffs, per-field accept/reject/undo controls, and trust signals for non-deterministic output. Part of a cross-functional team; owned field-level interaction patterns and explored extension into video and photo workflows.
- Designed a video analytics dashboard for enterprise publishers, surfacing engagement, monetization, and error metrics across aggregate and individual video views. Grounded in 6+ client interviews and a 37-person survey; iterated with stakeholders within hard technical constraints to reduce support burden on account management and engineering.
- Engineered a centralized design system supporting a dozen distinct products, managing component contributions across engineering teams directly in GitHub alongside AI-generated technical documentation and handoff protocols.
- Designed platform explainer visuals used by sales and C-suite at industry conferences, and contributed to web presence work for a publisher-facing marketing property.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Design: Figma, Design Systems, Information Architecture, Cross-functional Handoff

Research & Strategy: UX Research, User Testing, Competitive Analysis, Datadog, Pendo

AI & Engineering: Generative AI, Figma Make (shipped product); Claude (workflow and documentation); HTML/CSS/JavaScript, Python/C, React, GitHub, Agile

EDUCATION

Carnegie Mellon University

May 2022

BS. Information Systems and Human Computer Interaction

- Led two independent product teams delivering solutions for a nonprofit and an ed-tech startup. Owned problem definition, solution scoping, and full design through handoff.